

ALEXANDER
WATSON

BRAND SYSTEM

Brand & Digital Identity Guidelines

A consistent identity across every place I appear.



PREPARED BY

Alexander Watson

VERSION

1.0 · August 2026

COMPANION TO

Practice Clarity

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Section 01

Foundation

Purpose, positioning, values and architecture.

To bring clarity to thoughtful work and express it with care.

Alexander Watson helps therapists turn the thinking behind their practice into a clear professional identity, visual system and website that feels true to them.

The identity should communicate care, clarity, thoughtfulness and professional confidence without feeling corporate or performative.

For therapists who want to be understood without becoming a performance.

Clarity before design.

Substance before spectacle.

Thoughtful collaboration rather than imposed branding.

Professional confidence without marketing noise.

Alexander Watson works with thoughtful therapists who want a coherent professional identity and online presence that genuinely reflects their practice.

Calm · Crafted · True

Calm

Clear, spacious and emotionally steady. Never demanding attention.

Crafted

Intentional in every detail. Built carefully rather than rushed.

True

Honest, human and aligned with the person or practice behind the work.

One identity. Different contexts.

Alexander Watson is the master identity used across studio work, counselling, writing and personal online presence. The subject and purpose may change, but the underlying visual language remains consistent.

Alexander Watson

Master personal and professional identity

Counselling and Therapeutic Work

Professional practice context

Website Design for Therapists

Primary commercial service

Writing and Personal Projects

Publishing and creative context

These contexts use service descriptors, not separate logos. Do not create sub-brand marks or additional visual identities.

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Section 02

Logo System

Wordmark, monogram, clear space, minimum sizes and incorrect usage.

The approved marks.

The Alexander Watson wordmark is supplied as drawn vector artwork. It is not typeset and must never be re-set in a typeface, redrawn, respaced or approximated. Only two things may vary: the width it is placed at, and the colour variant.



Primary wordmark

Logo Ink on Warm White. The default in every application.



Alternate wordmark

The flanking-rule lockup, for centred placements.



Submark

Avatars, favicons and square formats only.



Reversed

Warm White on Deep Forest, for dark grounds.

Space is part of the mark.



Clear space on all four sides equals the cap height of the “A” in ALEXANDER — measured from the artwork as **0.1168 × the lockup width**. At the 240pt lockup shown here that is 28.0pt. Nothing may enter this field: no text, no rule, no image edge.

MINIMUM SIZE — SHOWN AT TRUE SIZE

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Digital minimum — 120px wide.

A

Submark minimum — 24px wide.

Print

30mm width minimum for the full wordmark.

Digital

120px width minimum for the full wordmark.

Submark

24px minimum. Below this, use no mark at all.

Never

Scale the wordmark below its minimum to fit a space. Change the space instead.

Six things never to do.

Each example below uses the real artwork, misused. These rules protect the mark's clarity and the quiet confidence it depends on.



✕ Do not stretch or distort



✕ Do not rotate the wordmark



✕ Do not add shadows or effects



✕ Do not recolour outside the palette



✕ Do not place on busy or low-contrast ground



✕ Do not re-set the wordmark in a typeface

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Section 03

Colour

Palette, specification, proportion and contrast.

Every colour exists for a reason.

The palette is deliberately restrained — warm, muted and grounded in nature. Colour should never compete for attention; it should quietly support hierarchy, readability and emotional tone.

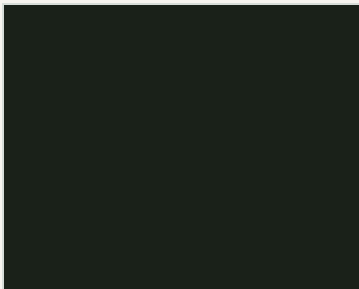
INKS AND ACCENTS · GROUNDS AND NEUTRALS



Deep Forest

PRIMARY TEXT,
DIVIDERS

HEX #283A38
RGB 40 58 56
CMYK 80 58 62 45



Logo Ink

WORDMARK, DEEPEST
TEXT

HEX #1A2119
RGB 26 33 25
CMYK 76 60 74 68



Charcoal

SECONDARY, LABELS

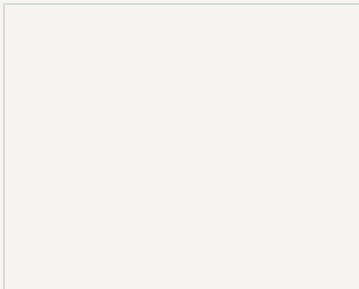
HEX #5F6A68
RGB 95 106 104
CMYK 63 46 50 15



Sage

ACCENT, RULES,
DISPLAY

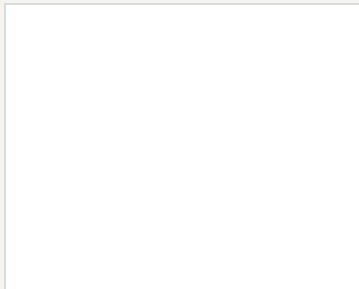
HEX #798371
RGB 121 131 113
CMYK 56 40 60 10



Warm White

PRIMARY GROUND

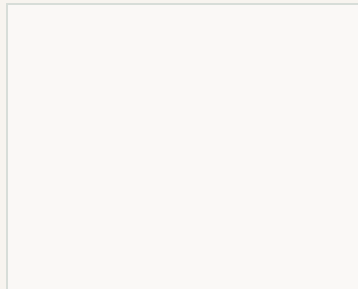
HEX #F7F4EF
RGB 247 244 239
CMYK 2 3 6 0



White

CARDS, IMAGE
MOUNTS

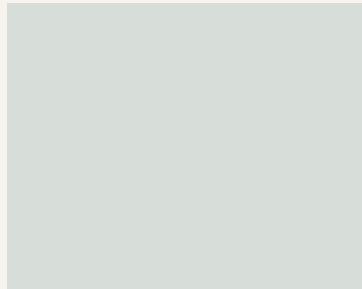
HEX #FFFFFF
RGB 255 255 255
CMYK 0 0 0 0



Cream

SECONDARY PANEL
GROUND

HEX #FAF8F6
RGB 250 248 246
CMYK 12 3 0



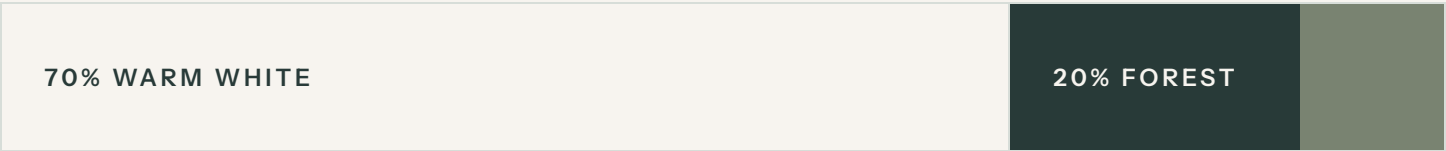
Soft Stone

HAIRLINES, BORDERS

HEX #D7DDD8
RGB 215 221 216
CMYK 16 8 15 0

Proportion, hierarchy and contrast.

PROPORTION



70% Warm White grounds · 20% Deep Forest and Logo Ink · 10% Sage and Soft Stone

BACKGROUND HIERARCHY

Level 1 — Warm White

Primary surfaces.

Level 2 — White

Cards and high-contrast surfaces.

Level 3 — Deep Forest

Contrast sections, used sparingly.

Level 4 — Soft Stone

Subtle background separation.

CONTRAST — MEASURED, NOT ASSUMED

PAIRING	RATIO	WCAG AA	USE FOR
Deep Forest on Warm White	10.9:1	Pass	Body, headings
Charcoal on Warm White	5.1:1	Pass	Secondary, labels
Warm White on Deep Forest	10.9:1	Pass	Reversed body
Soft Stone on Deep Forest	8.7:1	Pass	Reversed secondary
Sage on Warm White	3.6:1	Large only	Display 24pt+
Warm White on Sage	3.6:1	Fails	Never as a ground
Charcoal on Deep Forest	2.1:1	Fails	Never

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Section 04

Typography

The typefaces, hierarchy and typesetting rules.

Two families. Three cuts.

The exact font files self-hosted by the counselling website, so a document and a web page read as one voice.

Newsreader

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890

Cuts

Display (72pt optical) for 24pt and above. Text (16pt optical) for anything smaller. They are not interchangeable.

Role

All display, headings, statements, serif terms and field values. NOT the wordmark — that is separate drawn artwork.

Weight

Regular only. There is no bold serif; hierarchy comes from size.

Licence

SIL Open Font Licence 1.1. Copyright 2020 The Newsreader Project Authors. Embedding and redistribution permitted.

Instrument Sans

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890

Cuts

Regular 400 and Semibold 600. 600 is the only bold in the system; never request 700.

Role

Body text, leads, labels, captions, tables and data.

Licence

SIL Open Font Licence 1.1. Copyright 2022 The Instrument Sans Project Authors. Embedding and redistribution permitted.

Italics

None are supplied in either family. Font synthesis is switched off, so nothing renders a faked slant.

The same files, on both sides.

These documents embed the font files from the website’s own assets/fonts folder, unmodified.

THE SUPPLIED SET

newsreader-display-400

Headings, statements and display type, 24pt and above.

newsreader-text-400

Serif terms, field values and quoted language below 24pt.

instrument-sans-400

Body text, leads, captions and table data.

instrument-sans-600

Labels, eyebrows, running heads and folios.

HANDOVER AND LICENCE

May these be embedded in a PDF?

Yes. The SIL Open Font Licence expressly permits embedding, and states that documents created with the fonts are not themselves encumbered.

May they be handed to a client?

Yes. Redistribution is permitted provided the licence travels with the files. OFL.txt sits alongside them in system/fonts/.

What may not be done

The fonts may not be sold on their own, and a modified font may not keep the Newsreader or Instrument Sans name.

Eight levels. No others.

DISPLAY 88PT / 1.04 / NEWSREADER DISPLAY	Clarity before design	COVERS
STATEMENT 64PT / 1.14 / NEWSREADER DISPLAY	Clarity before design	DIVIDERS, STATEMENTS
SECTION 48PT / 1.14 / NEWSREADER DISPLAY	Clarity before design	PAGE TITLES
ITEM 22PT / 1.26 / NEWSREADER TEXT	Clarity before design	SUBHEADS, TERMS
LEDE 20PT / 1.56 / INSTRUMENT SANS	Clarity before design	STANDFIRST
BODY 16PT / 1.62 / INSTRUMENT SANS	Clarity before design	BODY
LABEL 11PT / +.16EM / INSTRUMENT SANS 600	CLARITY BEFORE DESIGN	EYEBROWS
DETAIL 13.5PT / 1.62 / INSTRUMENT SANS	Clarity before design	CAPTIONS, NOTES

The rules that hold it together.

Tracking, line height and measure are taken verbatim from the website's token layer.

Tracking

Display -0.028em · statements -0.025em · headings -0.020em · items -0.012em · labels $+0.16\text{em}$ · numerals $+0.10\text{em}$.

Line height

1.04 display · 1.14 headings · 1.26 items · 1.56 ledes · 1.62 body · 1.40 labels.

Measure

Body 66ch, tight 54ch, ledes 48ch, statements 21ch.
Reading copy lands at roughly 55–70 characters per line.

Alignment

Body always left-aligned, never justified. Right-alignment is reserved for folios and metadata.

Weight

Headings are always Regular. There is no bold serif — hierarchy comes from size and space. The only bold is Instrument Sans 600.

Capitals

Labels and eyebrows only, at $+0.16\text{em}$. Never a heading, never a full sentence.

Numerals

Tabular lining figures in tables, folios and numbered lists.

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Section 05

Graphic Language

Rules, borders, components and spacing.

Earn your place or be removed.

The graphic language is deliberately minimal. It exists to create structure, not decoration.

Corner radius

3pt for cards and containers. 0 for structural elements.
Never fully rounded.

Borders

0.5pt in Soft Stone. Used to define an edge, never to decorate. A border should read as a whisper, not a frame.

Shadows

None, anywhere. Elevation is communicated through whitespace and background shift.

Dividers

0.5pt horizontal rules in Soft Stone, separating content sections. Never placed directly beneath a heading.

Icons

Outline only, 1.5px stroke, minimal detail. Never filled, never coloured, never decorative.

The A motif

Permitted on covers, section dividers and closing pages only. One fixed geometry each. Never on an editorial page.

COMPONENTS

Make an initial enquiry

Read about my approach

Your name

Your name — focus state

Everything is a multiple of eight.

All spacing derives from an 8pt base unit. This creates rhythm without requiring conscious effort from the designer.

XS		8pt — Inner padding, tight gaps
SM		16pt — Element spacing
MD		24pt — Section padding
LG		48pt — Component gaps
XL		96pt — Section separation
2XL		128pt — Page margins

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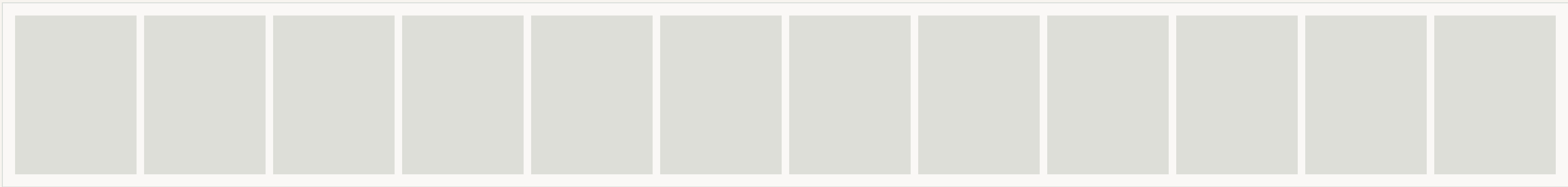
Section 06

Layout

Grid, margins, measure and rhythm.

The grid is invisible to the reader.

They simply feel that everything belongs.



Grid

12 columns for websites and documents. 6 for presentations. 4 for mobile. 24pt gutters.

Margins

Document 96pt. Desktop 120px. Tablet 64px. Mobile 24px. Print 25mm. Margins are never crossed except by full-bleed colour.

Maximum width

Content container 1200px. Reading width 680px. Never wider, regardless of viewport.

Section spacing

96pt between major sections on desktop, 64pt on tablet, 48pt on mobile.

Responsive

Desktop-first, gracefully simplified. Elements stack vertically. Typography reduces by one step at each breakpoint.

Whitespace

Not empty space but active design. When in doubt, add space rather than content.

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Section 07

Photography

Art direction, ratios and treatment.

Cinematic, natural, editorial.

Photography communicates what words cannot. Never staged, never generic, never decorative.

Lighting

Natural light, always. Soft, directional, with gentle shadows that create depth. Golden hour and overcast preferred. Never flash.

Composition

Generous negative space. Subject placed off-centre using natural framing. Architectural lines and leading geometry.

Colour grading

Warm, muted tones, slightly desaturated. Shadows lifted gently towards warm brown. Never oversaturated, never cool-toned.

Interiors

Calm, considered spaces. Natural materials — wood, stone, linen, concrete. Lived-in but intentional.

Portraits

Candid and natural. Subject at ease, never performing. Environmental context preferred over studio isolation.

Nature and objects

Textural close-ups. Weathered surfaces, organic forms, honest imperfections. Never styled to perfection.

Four ratios. No others.

3 : 4

Environmental portraits.

Portrait

4 : 5

Social and editorial columns.

Portrait alternate

16 : 9

Interiors, architecture, landscape.

Environmental

1 : 1

Textures and still life.

Detail

Images are mounted on White with no border, no radius and no shadow. Captions sit below at 12pt in Charcoal, one line, sentence case: subject then treatment. Avoid stock photography, forced smiles, bright saturated colour, busy backgrounds and generic wellness imagery.

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Section 08

Application

Website, documents and digital presence.

Components should feel invisible.

Navigation

Fixed top. Wordmark left, minimal links right. No dropdowns unless essential. 64px height. Transparent on hero, solid on scroll.

Hero sections

Full width. Single image or solid colour. Headline left-aligned. Maximum 12 words. 160px minimum vertical padding.

Cards

White background. 0.5pt Soft Stone border. 3pt radius. 32pt padding. Image above, heading below, body last. No hover shadow.

Buttons

Primary solid Deep Forest with Warm White text. Secondary 1pt Deep Forest outline. 48px height, 24px horizontal padding, 3pt radius.

Testimonials

Pull-quote style in Newsreader Text. Attribution below in Instrument Sans. No quotation marks, no background card.

Forms

Single column. Labels above fields. 48px field height. 0.5pt Soft Stone border. Focus state 1pt Deep Forest. Never placeholder text as a label.

Footers

Minimal. Wordmark, essential links, copyright. No social icons unless necessary.

Calls to action

One primary action per section. Describe the outcome. Never “Click here” or “Learn more”.

Every document carries the same authority.

Consistency across touchpoints builds recognition and trust without requiring conscious effort from the reader.

Practice Clarity

1440 × 810pt landscape. This system. Newsreader titles, 96pt margins, Warm White ground.

Presentations

1920 × 1080px. One idea per slide. Large editorial headings, minimal body text.

Proposals and reports

A4 portrait. Cover with wordmark and title only. Contents page and section dividers.

Invoices and letters

A4 portrait. Wordmark top-left, date top-right. Clean tabular data. No decorative elements.

Business cards

85 × 55mm. Wordmark front, contact reverse. Warm white uncoated stock. No gloss, no foil.

Email signatures

Wordmark as text, not image. Name, role, one link. No social icons, no inspirational quotes.

Digital products

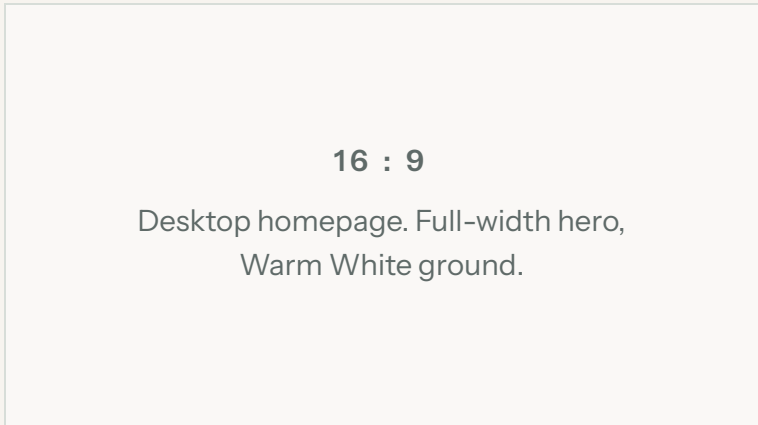
Templates and course materials follow the same grid, typography and colour system.

Client portal

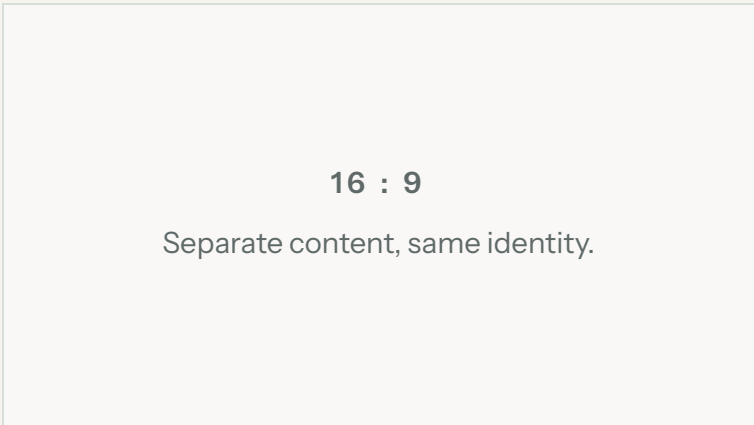
Clean navigation. Warm White ground. Document cards with 0.5pt borders. Clarity over features.

Different content. One identity.

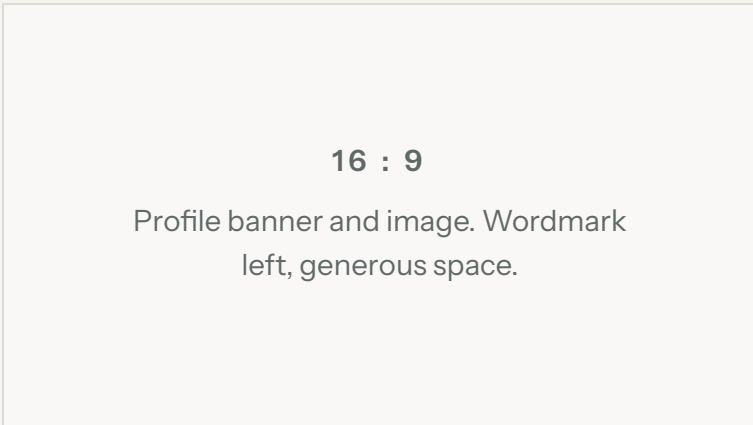
The two websites have different content and purposes, but must feel visibly related through typography, colour, spacing, photography and logo use.



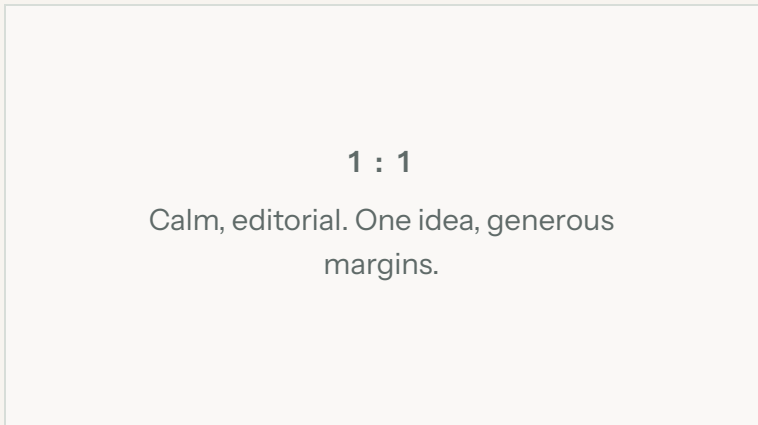
alexanderwatson.co.uk



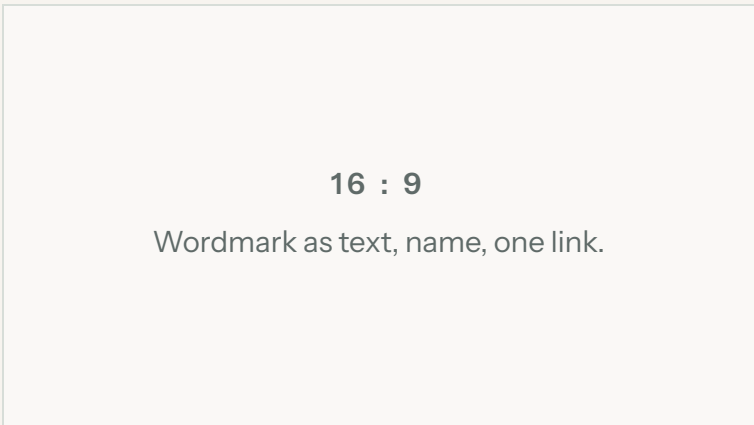
Counselling website



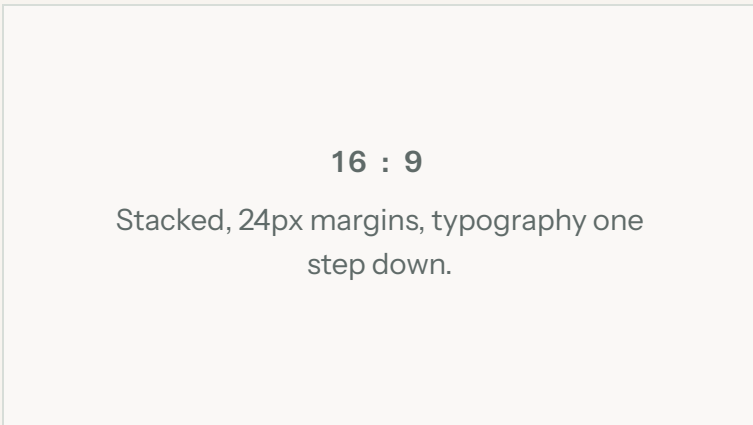
LinkedIn



Social post template



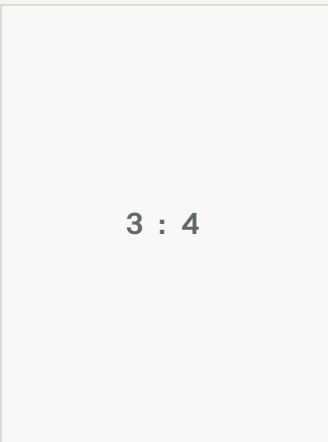
Email signature



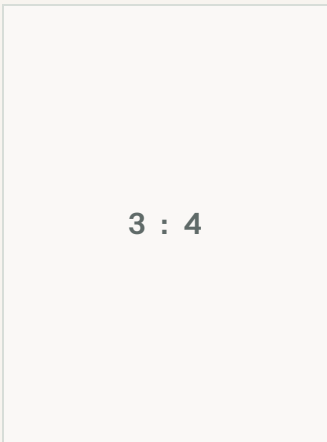
Mobile homepage

Calm, thoughtful, recognisably connected.

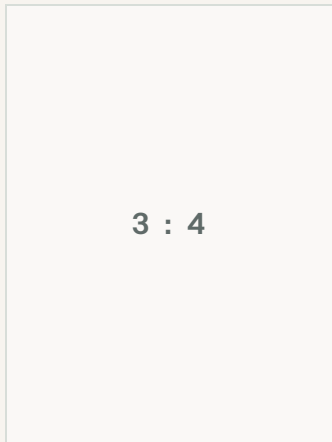
Every client document uses the approved wordmark, a Warm White ground, generous margins and minimal borders.



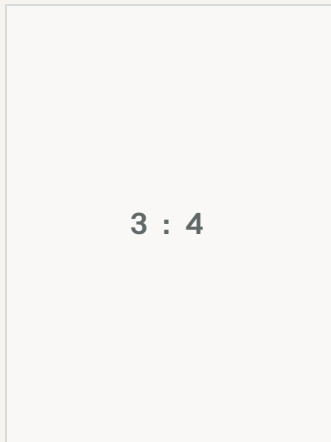
Practice Clarity



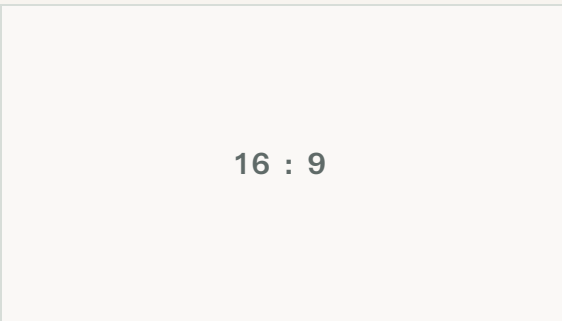
Discovery workbook



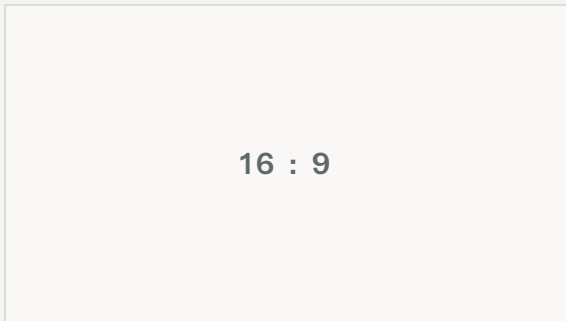
Project proposal



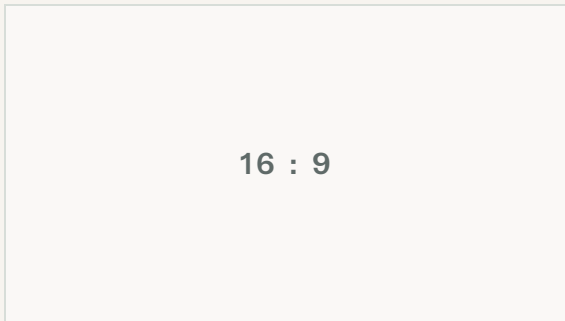
Invoice / letterhead



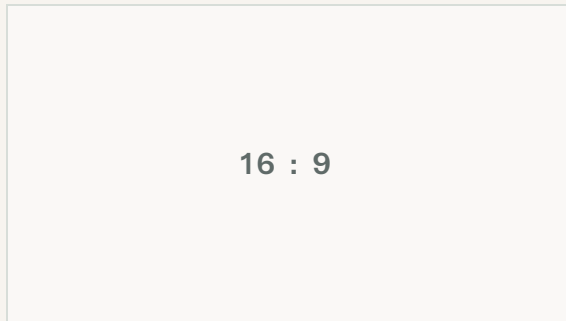
PDF guide



Brand presentation



Website handover



Email newsletter

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Section 09

Voice

How we speak, write and communicate.

Calm confidence, clarity, considered expertise.

Clear British English, avoiding hype, jargon and marketing clichés. Every word should feel considered, premium and quietly authoritative.

Vocabulary

Simple, precise, warm. Prefer ‘considered’ over ‘strategic’. ‘Clarity’ over ‘optimisation’. ‘Thoughtful’ over ‘innovative’.

Sentence length

Short to medium. Maximum 25 words. One idea per sentence. Paragraphs of two to three sentences.

Headlines

Direct and calm. State what something is, not what it does. ‘Practice Clarity’, not ‘10 Steps to Transform Your Brand’. Never an exclamation mark.

Warmth and authority

Warm but never casual. Authoritative but never condescending. A trusted advisor who has done the thinking and shares it generously.

Calls to action

Specific and honest. ‘Begin your blueprint’, not ‘Get started now’. Describe the outcome, never the urgency.

Emails

Personal, direct, respectful of time. Subject lines that describe content honestly. Sign off with a name only.

Language that does not belong here.

NEVER

“Game-changer”
“Disruptive”
“Leverage”
“Synergy”
“Unlock your potential”
“Limited time offer”

“Don’t miss out”

SOCIAL MEDIA

Same voice, shorter form. No hashtag culture. No trending language.
Share thinking, not promotion. Every post should teach or reflect.

Urgency is never used as a tool. If something is genuinely time-limited, say so plainly once and move on.

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Section 10

Stewardship

What holds, what evolves, and the standard.

Different purposes. One identity.

Alexander Watson Studio

Websites and identity systems for therapists

Alexander Watson Counselling

Counselling and therapeutic practice

Alexander Watson

Writing, professional reflection and publishing

The content changes. The standard does not.

Thirteen questions.

— Does this feel calm and considered?

— Is the approved logo being used correctly?

— Is the typography consistent with the system?

— Does the colour palette remain within the defined brand colours?

— Is there enough whitespace for the content to breathe?

— Is the hierarchy immediately clear?

— Does every visual element earn its place?

— Is the photography natural, editorial and emotionally credible?

— Is the writing honest, warm and free from jargon?

— Does the experience reduce cognitive load?

— Does this build trust?

— Would this still feel appropriate in five to ten years?

— Does this clearly belong to Alexander Watson?

If the answer to an important question is no, the work is not ready.

What may change, and what may not.

A brand built on timelessness must still evolve. The question is never whether to change, but what is permitted to change.

WHAT REMAINS CONSTANT

- Approved logo family
- Calm, clear and honest voice
- Restrained colour palette
- Newsreader and Instrument Sans relationship
- Generous whitespace
- Editorial photography
- Clarity before cleverness
- Substance before spectacle

WHAT CAN EVOLVE

- Website components
- Content formats
- Layout adaptations for new platforms
- Photography subjects
- Accessibility standards
- Motion and interaction principles
- New document templates

The Alexander Watson standard.

Whenever someone encounters Alexander Watson through a website, document, email, presentation, social post or future product, the experience should feel calm, clear, thoughtful and trustworthy.

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Calm. Clarity. Care. Quiet confidence.

Every future project should feel as though it belongs alongside every previous one. Not because everything looks identical, but because it shares the same values, judgement and quiet authority.

